Jean Abel Msabila

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jeanmsabila Google Scholar

EDUCATION

West Virginia University Morgantown, WV
Ph.D. in Economics *Aug 2024 – Expected May 2028*
- **Fields:** Health Economics, Public Economics, Urban and Regional Economics, Monetary Economics, Natural Resource Economics, Applied Microeconometrics.

M.A. in Economics *Aug 2023 – Expected May 2027*

World Trade Institute, University of Bern Bern, Switzerland
M.A. in International Law and Economics (Cum Laude) 2010–2011

Sokoine University of Agriculture Morogoro, Tanzania
B.Sc. in Agricultural Economics and Agribusiness 2004–2007

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Health Economics; Development Economics; Applied Microeconomics

PUBLICATIONS

- Msabila, Jean Abel (2026). "The Political Economy of Trade: Evidence from Congressional Voting on HR 434." *Critical Letters in Economics & Finance*, 3(2), Article 2.

WORKING PAPERS

- "Rainfall Shocks, Household Hardship, and Credit: Evidence from Eight Developing Countries." With Glory Adebayo, Sodiq Oladipupo, Comfort Adama, and Elizabeth Ogechi. Under review at *World Development*.
- "Starved in the Womb: The Biafran Blockade and Men's Schooling." With Glory David Adebayo. Under review at *Economics Letters*.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "What Does a Medicaid Dollar Buy? Hospital Finances and Patient Care under State Directed Payments."
- "Losing the Safety Net: Syringe Services Disruptions, Overdose, and Infection." With Christine Bretschneider-Fries.
- "Paid Sick Leave Mandates and Childhood Vaccination."
- "Out of the Haze: Wildfire Smoke, Outdoor Exercise, and the Allocation of Daily Time."
- "Time Constraints and Participation in Physical Activity: Evidence from Time Use Survey Data, 2003–2025." With Brad R. Humphreys and Jane E. Ruseski.
- "Effect of Medicaid Expansion on Mental Health Outcomes in the United States."

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

West Virginia University (WVU) Morgantown, WV

Graduate Assistant, Department of Economics Aug 2024 – Present

Instructor of Record, Department of Economics

- ECON 201 Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2026)

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics

- ECON 201 Principles of Microeconomics (Spring 2026)
- ECON 225 Business and Economics Statistics (Fall 2025)
- ECON 201 Principles of Microeconomics (Spring 2025)
- ECON 202 Principles of Macroeconomics (Fall 2024)
- ECON 200 Survey of Economics (Fall 2024)

Research – WVU Extension Service

- Conduct empirical research on health economics and public policy, including Medicaid expansion, mental health, and harm reduction.
- Analyze large survey and policy datasets using econometric methods and statistical software.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ministry of Foreign Affairs and East African Cooperation Tanzania

Principal Economist Oct 2022 – May 2023

- Coordinated annual budget preparation and interministerial economic policy briefings.

Embassy of the United Republic of Tanzania Washington, D.C.

Principal Economist (Minister Counselor) Sep 2017 – Oct 2022

- Led economic policy analysis on Tanzania–U.S. trade and investment, including AGOA; worked on development-policy matters involving the World Bank Group and IMF.
- Served as *Chargé d'Affaires a.i.* and *Acting Head of Chancery*, overseeing mission operations.

Government of the United Republic of Tanzania Tanzania

Economist, Ministry of Foreign Affairs and East African Cooperation 2017

Economist, National Council for Technical Education 2016 – 2017

Economist, Ministry of Industry, Trade and Investment 2009 – 2016

- *Special Assistant to the Permanent Secretary* 2012 – 2013

FELLOWSHIPS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

- Graduate Assistantship, West Virginia University Aug 2024 – May 2028
- WTO Advanced Trade Policy Course Scholarship 2016
- Netherlands Fellowship Programme (NFP) 2014
- Australia Awards Scholarship 2014
- SECO Master Scholarship, University of Bern 2010 – 2011

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Software: Stata, R, Python, MATLAB, LaTeX, Git, SPSS

Teaching platforms: Pear Deck, eCampus, Blackboard

Languages: English (fluent); Swahili (native)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- American Economic Association (AEA)
- Association for the Advancement of African Women Economists (AAAWE)

REFERENCES

Dr. Daniel Grossman
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West Virginia University
(304) 293-7860
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Prof. Jane E. Ruseski
John Chambers College of
Business & Economics
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